

his teammates to excel too. Teamwork is essential to help an individual excel in football. As a fan, yes, I would have been excited to see the match. But as a footballer playing the game, my goal would be to help the team.

FIFA World Cup 2026 will have 32 teams in the first knockout phase, which means only 16 teams will be eliminated after the league round. Isn't it easier to qualify for the knockouts now?

Well, this is another angle, true. But for me, that is never a concern. We need to play at our best against the three best countries in the group

distance this time?

There are plenty! The European and South American giants will always be ahead in the race. But the Africans and Asians are also coming up. It will be a super-exciting tournament, and the teams with the fewest mistakes on the field will be better placed to win it.

phase, that's all. The 48 best football-playing nations will be there, and we are one of them. Now, it all depends on how one performs on a given day. Anything can happen here. So, our focus will be on the opponent on each of those three matchdays and on giving our best.

Which teams have the ability and footballers to go the



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